Council of Constance, and then had stepped back and allowed him to burn. Hussite fury over the betrayal was widespread, but one Bohemian knight in particular emerged as Sigismund's opponent: the soldier John Zizka, veteran of wars against the Teutonic Order of Prussia, an ex-captain of the dead Wenceslaus IV. He began to drill the Bohemian peasants, armed with grain flails and riding in wagons, into an actual army. Sigismund, not daring to enter the country, sent a German army ahead of him into Prague; Zizka and his peasants drove the German soldiers back.[4]

They now demanded the rights that Jan Hus had begun to preach, as spelled out by the Hussite leaders and submitted to Sigismund: the Four Articles of Prague. The Articles asked the king of Germany, first, to allow open preaching of the Gospel without restriction; second, to permit the Eucharist served *sub utraque specie*, "in both kinds" (in the Bohemian churches, a practice had evolved since the twelfth century of serving the bread to the Christians in the pews, but reserving the wine for ordained priests alone);* third, to require all clergy to take a vow of poverty, giving up the Church's right to accumulate wealth; and finally, to punish actions "against divine law" (*legi divinae contrariae*) openly and promptly. Specific sins were mentioned: drunkenness and theft; adultery and wantonness; unjustified tax and interest rate hikes; the sudden raising of feudal rents. Like the Cathars, like the Waldensians, the Hussites fought against *all* entitlement and privilege.[5]

Sigismund refused to grant the Articles. But in the ongoing battles between German and Hussite forces—led by Zizka and then, after his death from plague, by the scholar-soldier Prokop the Shaven—he lost more and more ground. The sound of the Hussite battle hymn "Ye Warriors of God," sung by the armed and trained peasants as they marched into battle, was more often than not the sound of German defeat.

> Blessed is everyone who dies for the truth.
> Therefore archers and lancers,
> Of knightly rank,
> Pikemen and flailsmen,
> Of the common people,
> Keep ye all in mind the generous Lord! . . .
> Feel the pride of the weapon in your hands,
> And cry: "God is our Lord!"[6]

In 1421, with Sigismund stalled outside Prague, the Bohemian Diet (the gathered princes of the kingdom) declared him deposed. By 1427, the